project.org

LIBRARY LESSON PLAN

My Eyes Can Play Tricks!

PreK–Kindergarten · Library · 20 minutes

A read-aloud and exploration session where our youngest learners discover that what they see isn't always what's really there — building early foundations for critical thinking.

LESSON TIMING

3 min	8 min	5 min	2 min
GATHERING & HOOK	READ-ALOUD	MINI MUSEUM	CLOSING

LEARNING OBJECTIVE

Students will understand that our eyes can sometimes be "tricked," practice looking carefully before deciding, and connect this to books in the library.

STANDARDS ALIGNMENT

- **AASL I.A.2:** Recall prior knowledge as context for new meaning
- **TEKS §110.2 (K) 1A:** Listen actively and ask questions

MATERIALS NEEDED

- Picture book: *Duck! Rabbit!* by Amy Krouse Rosenthal (or similar)
- Large printed optical illusions (age-appropriate, 3–4 examples)
- Mini Museum artifacts OR virtual exhibition access
- Optional: student handouts

RECOMMENDED READ-ALOUD BOOKS

Duck! Rabbit! by Amy Krouse Rosenthal & Tom Lichtenheld — Two narrators argue about what they see. Perfect for multiple perspectives.

Round Trip by Ann Jonas — Black-and-white book tells one story, flip upside-down for a different picture!

LESSON PLAN · GATHERING & HOOK · 3 MINUTES

As students settle, hold up a large ambiguous image (duck/rabbit or vase/faces).

"Good morning, friends! I have a mystery picture. Look carefully… what do you see?"

Let children call out — they will disagree!

"Wow! Some see a duck, some see a rabbit. You're ALL right! This is an optical illusion — it tricks your eyes into seeing TWO different things!"

READ-ALOUD: DUCK! RABBIT! · 8 MINUTES

"I have a book about two friends looking at the SAME picture. But they can't agree! Let's find out what happens."

During reading: Pause to let children point out duck vs. rabbit features. Ask: *"What do YOU see? Did it change?"*

After reading: *"The friends kept arguing, but we learned: one picture can look different to different people. Neither is wrong!"*

MINI MUSEUM EXPLORATION · 5 MINUTES

"Now I'll show you something VERY special from long ago — before your grandparents were born! People back then LOVED eye tricks too."

Option 1 — Physical visit: Bring students to view Mini Museum artifacts.

Option 2 — Virtual visit: Show minimuseumproject.org/exhibitions/seeing-is-deceiving

Victorian illusion cards: *"Does it look like it's moving? It's not — your eyes are playing a trick!"*

Stereoscope: *"This old machine makes flat pictures look like they pop out!"*

CLOSING · 2 MINUTES

"Today we learned our eyes can be tricked! That's why it's SO important to look carefully, ask questions, and listen when someone sees differently. You might BOTH be right!"

Exit question: *"If your friend sees something different than you, what should you do?"*

OPTIONAL EXTENSION

Students draw their own "trick picture" that could be two things. Example: a circle = sun OR ball OR pizza!

DIFFERENTIATED STUDENT HANDOUTS

GREEN LEVEL
MORE SUPPORT

Look at three trick pictures and circle what you see first.

YELLOW LEVEL
GRADE LEVEL

Draw something that could be TWO things.

RED LEVEL
GO DEEPER

Create a trick picture, then test it on three people.

MINI MUSEUM CONNECTION

This lesson introduces the exhibition's core concept: our eyes and brains work together to see, and sometimes they can be fooled. Victorian artifacts provide a tangible, historical connection.

minimuseumproject.org/exhibitions/seeing-is-deceiving

ASSESSMENT

Observation: Can students identify that an ambiguous image shows two things? Do they engage with seeing differently?

BOOK DISPLAY

"Look Again!" display: *Duck! Rabbit!*, *Round Trip*, *Look! Look! Look!*, *It Looked Like Spilt Milk*, *I Spy*, *Where's Waldo?*